

LIVE



NEWSPAPER

20th February, 2018

ITEM WISE EDITORIALS

8th WEEK



INDIA – NEPAL ... RESET

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... INDIA AND ITS NEIGHBOURHOOD-RELATIONS.

3

A Nepal-India win-win

The new Prime Minister in Kathmandu needs a hands-off New Delhi to ensure mutually beneficial stability and growth



KANAK MANI DIXIT

Without doubt, like every nation-state, India seeks its own advantage in international relationships, including within the South Asian region. But the repeated experience is that of New Delhi generating animosities, with attitudes and actions that go against its own interests. This forces one to ask from nearby Kathmandu, is there a structural issue with India's foreign affairs oversight – or is this question itself taboo?

Take the case of Nepal, a country where friendship with India comes naturally even more than being a necessity, due to cultural, social and economic linkages over the open border. But, perhaps because of global preoccupations, New Delhi seems to constantly underestimate Kathmandu's fierce sense of self. The strategem over the decades has been to try to influence Kathmandu's politics, forgetting that they too survive within the milieu of Nepal's politics.

The legacy of 'big brother' started with Jawaharlal Nehru – Nepal's statesman B.P. Koirala in his memoir has pinpointed the precise moment in 1950 during a meeting at Teen Murti Bhawan when he realised that the fellow-revolutionary was now transformed as Prime Minister of India, inheriting the geopolitical inclinations of the departed colonialist.

The big stick

More recently, India became progressively interventionist as Nepal got mired in internal crisis during and after the Maoist 'people's war', and as the hill-plain polarisation escalated during the constitution writing. India has tended to speak loudly while wielding a big stick, based on a sense of entitlement and exceptionalism. But evidently, Indian nationalism for all its vigour cannot suppress national animosity across the frontier.

While there are of course nar-



GETTY IMAGES/SHUTTERSTOCK

rous domestic factors, a key reason for political instability in Nepal has been India's overt and covert interventions. This incident explains in part why Nepal has not had a Prime Minister in office for more than a year and a half over two decades now. Meanwhile, Indian analysts fail to appreciate how political stability in Nepal can deliver economic bounty to the bordering Indian States on its three sides. And economists should study the Pew Research Center figures showing Nepal as one of the larger sources of remittances to India, that too to the poorest regions such as north Bihar, east Uttar Pradesh and Odisha.

India is understandably apprehensive as the Chinese geo-economic juggernaut infiltrates the Subcontinental countries, including Nepal. Rather than its perpetual warnings against consorting with Beijing, however, better to leave each society to develop its own method on dealing with China. In the case of Nepal, the arrival of the Qinghai Tibet Railway at the northern border point in 2020 will be a game changer, and the Indian market too is set to benefit.

With Khadga Prasad Sharma Oli sworn in as Prime Minister on February 15, there is now opportunity to start afresh on India-Nepal. It is true that India has never had as adventurous a Prime Minister in Kathmandu as Mr. Oli, but this is mainly the result of New Delhi's own short-sightedness.

Mr. Oli has been a moderate (if loquacious) politician who does not bend easily to populist pressures, but it fell on him during his previous term to stand up to the devastating Great Blockade of 2015.

It became his job to rally a populace under humanitarian distress

and seek connectivity northward through a set of 90 agreements with Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing.

Tagging Mr. Oli as 'anti-Indian' is not sensible, for being 'pro-Nepal' does not ipso facto mean animosity towards India. And New Delhi may be surprised to find Mr. Oli more than willing to reciprocate its overtures, providing reassurance that Kathmandu will never act against India's security interests, while insisting that in all areas Nepal will take its own decisions. Nepal's politicians are masters at realpolitik, and the art of balancing India vis-à-vis China is not outside of Mr. Oli's personal skill set.

Desire for harmony

Thankfully, it does look like India is seeking a recalibration, and no one is asking for a public apology. The desire for rapprochement is seen in the three phone conversations Prime Minister Narendra Modi has had with Mr. Oli since December, and the dispatch of Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj to Kathmandu before the new government was even formed.

Nepal's topmost politicians, who never seem to retire, have got so used to revolving door leadership that they are finding it hard to stomach the five-year term that the new government will probably get. On the other hand, the people's expectation is that the longevity will ipso facto make for better governance.

Mr. Oli's ascendance to prime-ministership marks the final turn of the key in implementing the Constitution of Nepal (2015), which was adopted despite India's fervent lobbying. The promulgation marks an end to the extended derailment of the last two decades, with numerous tragedies

from the Maoist 'people's war' to the Great Blockade.

Nepal is now a federal and secular republic, experimenting with three levels of fully empowered government – central, provincial and local. But there is confusion on the division of powers between the tiers, and foot-dragging by the national bureaucracy and many powerful politicians, besides an antedated Constitutional Bench of the Supreme Court.

Ensuring inclusion

Mr. Oli inherits the share-the-spoils Bhagpanda politics of the transitional years, which has left the police, bureaucracy and judiciary politicised. The decay in each sphere cries out for reform, from the private sector cartels that control the economy to corruption that has seeped to the village terraces.

The central socio-political task is to ensure inclusion in governance, giving the Janjati ethnicities as well as the Madhesi plains people and others a feeling of ownership of the state. While seeking to restore Nepal's position internationally, Mr. Oli has to implement the connectivity agreements he signed with Beijing in 2015, while lifting the relationship with India above the paragon supplicant status. He will have his hands full trying to raise employment through tourism, industry, agroforestry and agriculture, ensuring energy self-sufficiency through hydro projects and rescuing the post-earthquake reconstruction effort, which has been a scandal. With international assistance in decline, investors have to be attracted by the promise of the rule of law and due process if Nepal is not to remain the playground of carpetbaggers.

Speaking of the rule of law, the human rights community is worried that the ongoing truth and reconciliation process might be used as a sham exercise to pardon wartime atrocities. With Nepal recently elected to the UN Human Rights Council, there is opportunity to raise Nepal's international profile, while finally putting the 'people's war' behind in all.

Mr. Oli is fortunate that the new Constitution ensures extended tenure, by not allowing a no-confi-

dence vote for the first two years. Besides, he rides a strong public mandate, having led the Left Alliance in its sweep of the local, provincial and national elections and forming governments at each tier. The field is also clear because the parties representing the Hinduva ideology and the deposed king, Gyanendra, were roundly defeated at all levels.

Reaching out

Mr. Oli's primary preoccupation will be managing the government's relationship with the opposition. The atmospherics between his Communist Party of Nepal (UML) and the Nepali Congress (NC) are at their worst, the latter sullen and vulnerable after the trouncing at the polls. He must reach out to build a working relationship with the NC and the Madheswadi plains-based parties, also because hundreds of new laws need to be urgently drafted under the Constitution.

The Prime Minister's immediate challenge, however, has to do with Pushpa Kamal Dahal ('Prachin'), his Maoist partner in the Left Alliance. Mr. Dahal prefers to ignore the reality that his party was rescued from decimation by the electoral bonding with the UML. The voters gave him a respectable showing, hoping that the promised unification would subsume the Maoists within the UML, helping finally to neutralise the former.

As this is being written, the two parties are preparing a unification document. Meanwhile, haggling for plum posts, Mr. Dahal is demanding an aloof, rotating prime-ministership. This would mean a jump back to Bhagpanda politics, endangering both stability and growth, disabouring the electoral mandate.

Prime Minister Oli is tasked today to land Mr. Dahal where he can do no further harm to Nepal's state and society, and to reset the relationship with India at a new normal. On the latter, he seems keen to take the olive branch held out by Mr. Modi, which can only result in a 'win-win' for Nepal and India.

Kanak Mani Dixit, a writer and journalist based in Kathmandu, is founding editor of the magazine, *Winning Southasia*

3 A Nepal-India win-win:

The new Prime Minister in Kathmandu needs a hands-off New Delhi to ensure mutually beneficial stability and growth

Without doubt, like every nation-state, India seeks its own advantage in international relationships, including within the South Asian region. But the repeated experience is that of New Delhi generating animosities, with attitudes and actions that go against its own interests. This forces one to ask from nearby Kathmandu, is there a structural issue with India's foreign affairs oversight — or is this question itself taboo?

Take the case of Nepal, a country where friendship with India comes naturally even more than being a necessity, due to cultural, social and economic linkages over the open border. But, perhaps because of global preoccupations, New Delhi seems to constantly under-estimate Kathmandu's fierce sense of self. The stratagem over the decades has been to try to influence Kathmandu's politicians, forgetting that they too survive within the milieu of Nepali politics.

The legacy of 'big brother' started with Jawaharlal Nehru — Nepal's statesman B.P. Koirala in his memoir has pinpointed the precise moment in 1950 during a meeting at Teen Murti Bhavan when he realised that the fellow-revolutionary was now transformed as Prime Minister of India, inheriting the geopolitical inclinations of the departed colonialist.

...Contd.



3 A Nepal-India win-win:

The big stick

More recently, India became progressively interventionist as Nepal got mired in internal crisis during and after the Maoist 'people's war', and as the hill-plain polarisation escalated during the constitution-writing. India has tended to speak loudly while wielding a big stick, based on a sense of entitlement and exceptionalism. But evidently, Indian nationalism for all its vigour cannot suppress nationalism across the frontier.

While there are of course numerous domestic factors, a key reason for political instability in Nepal has been India's overt and covert intercessions. This involvement explains in part why Nepal has not had a Prime Minister in office for more than a year-and-a-half over two decades now. Meanwhile, Indian analysts fail to appreciate how political stability in Nepal can deliver economic bounty to the bordering Indian States on its three sides. And economists should study the Pew Research Center figures showing Nepal as one of the larger sources of remittances to India, that too to the poorest regions such as north Bihar, east Uttar Pradesh and Odisha. India is understandably apprehensive as the Chinese geoeconomic juggernaut infiltrates the Subcontinental countries, including Nepal. Rather than imperious warnings against consorting with Beijing, however, better to leave each society to develop its own method on dealing with China. In the case of Nepal, the arrival of the Qinghai-Tibet Railway at the northern border point in 2020 will be a game-changer, and the Indian market too is set to benefit.

With Khadga Prasad Sharma Oli sworn in as Prime Minister on February 15, there is now opportunity to start afresh on India-Nepal. It is true that India has never had as adversarial a Prime Minister in Kathmandu as Mr. Oli, but this is mainly the result of New Delhi's own short-sightedness.

...Contd.



3 A Nepal-India win-win:

Mr. Oli has been a moderate (if loquacious) politician who does not bend easily to populist pressures, but it fell on him during his previous term to stand up to the devastating Great Blockade of 2015.

It became his job to rally a populace under humanitarian distress and seek connectivity northward through a set of 10 agreements with Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing.

Tagging Mr. Oli as 'anti-Indian' is not sensible, for being 'pro-Nepal' does not *ipso facto* mean animosity towards India. And New Delhi may be surprised to find Mr. Oli more than willing to reciprocate its overtures, providing reassurance that Kathmandu will never act against India's security interests, while insisting that in all areas Nepal will take its own decisions. Nepal's politicians are masters at realpolitik, and the art of balancing India *vis-à-vis* China is not outside of Mr. Oli's personal skill-set.

Desire for harmony

Thankfully, it does look like India is seeking a recalibration, and no one is asking for a public apology. The desire for rapprochement is seen in the three phone conversations Prime Minister Narendra Modi has had with Mr. Oli since December, and the dispatch of Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj to Kathmandu before the new government was even formed.

Nepal's topmost politicians, who never seem to retire, have got so used to revolving-door leadership that they are finding it hard to stomach the five-year term that the new government will probably get. On the other hand, the people's expectation is that the longevity will *ipso facto* make for better governance.

...Contd.

3 A Nepal-India win-win:

Mr. Oli's ascendance to prime-ministership marks the final turn of the key in implementing the Constitution of Nepal (2015), which was adopted despite India's fervent lobbying. The promulgation marks an end to the extended derailment of the last two decades, with numerous tragedies from the Maoists 'people's war' to the Great Blockade.

Nepal is now a federal and secular republic, experimenting with three levels of fully empowered government — central, provincial and local. But there is confusion on the division of powers between the tiers, and foot-dragging by the national bureaucracy and many powerful politicians, besides an untested Constitutional Bench of the Supreme Court.

Ensuring inclusion

Mr. Oli inherits the share-the-spoils *bhagbanda* politics of the transitional years, which has left the police, bureaucracy and judiciary politicised. The decay in each sphere cries out for reform, from the private sector cartels that control the economy to corruption that has seeped to the village terraces.

The central socio-political task is to ensure inclusion in governance, giving the Janjati ethnicities as well as the Madhesi plains people and others a feeling of ownership of the state. While seeking to restore Nepal's position internationally, Mr. Oli has to implement the connectivity agreements he signed with Beijing in 2015, while lifting the relationship with India above the patron-suppliant status. He will have his hands full trying to raise employment through tourism, industry, agroforestry and agriculture, ensuring energy self-sufficiency through hydro projects and rescuing the post-earthquake reconstruction effort, which has been a scandal. With international assistance in decline, investors have to be attracted by the promise of the rule of law and due process if Nepal is not to remain the playground of carpetbaggers.

3 A Nepal-India win-win:

Speaking of the rule of law, the human rights community is worried that the ongoing truth and reconciliation process might be used as a sham exercise to pardon wartime atrocities. With Nepal recently elected to the UN Human Rights Council, there is opportunity to raise Nepal's international profile while finally putting the 'people's war' behind us all.

Mr. Oli is fortunate that the new Constitution ensures extended tenure, by not allowing a no-confidence vote for the first two years. Besides, he rides a strong public mandate, having led the Left Alliance in its sweep of the local, provincial and national elections and forming governments at each tier. The field is also clear because the parties representing the Hindutva ideology and the deposed king, Gyanendra, were roundly defeated at all levels.

Reaching out

Mr. Oli's primary preoccupation will be managing the government's relationship with the opposition. The atmospherics between his Communist Party of Nepal (UML) and the Nepali Congress (NC) are at their worst, the latter sullen and vulnerable after the trouncing at the polls. He must reach out to build a working relationship with the NC and the Madhesbaadi plains-based parties, also because hundreds of new laws need to be urgently drafted under the Constitution.

...Contd.

3 A Nepal-India win-win:

The Prime Minister's immediate challenge, however, has to do with Pushpa Kamal Dahal ('Prachanda'), his Maoist partner in the Left Alliance. Mr. Dahal prefers to ignore the reality that his party was rescued from decimation by the electoral bonding with the UML. The voters gave him a respectable showing, hoping that the promised unification would subsume the Maoists within the UML, helping finally to neutralise the former. As this is being written, the two parties are preparing a unification document. Meanwhile, bargaining for plum posts, Mr. Dahal is demanding an *alopalo*, rotating prime-ministership. This would mean a jump back to *bhagbandapolitics*, endangering both stability and growth, dishonouring the electoral mandate. Prime Minister Oli is tasked today to land Mr. Dahal where he can do no further harm to Nepal's state and society, and to reset the relationship with India at a new normal. On the latter, he seems keen to take the olive branch held out by Mr. Modi, which can only result in a 'win-win' for Nepal and India.

Kanak Mani Dixit, a writer and journalist based in Kathmandu, is founding editor of the magazine, 'Himal Southasian'

3

A Nepal-India win-win

The new Prime Minister in Kathmandu needs a hands-off New Delhi to ensure mutually beneficial stability and growth



KANAK MANI DIXIT

Without doubt, like every nation-state, India seeks its own advantage in its international relationships, including within the South Asian region. But the repeated experience is that of New Delhi generating animosities, with attitudes and actions that go against its own interests. This forces one to ask from nearby Kathmandu, is there a structural issue with India's foreign affairs oversight – or is this question itself taboo?

Take the case of Nepal, a country where friendship with India comes naturally even more than being a necessity, due to cultural, social and economic linkages over the open border. But, perhaps because of global preoccupations, New Delhi seems to constantly underestimate Kathmandu's fierce sense of self. The strategists over the decades have been to try to influence Kathmandu's policies, forgetting that they too survive within the milieu of Nepali politics.

The legacy of 'big brother' started with Jawaharlal Nehru – Nepal's statesman B.P. Koirala in his memoir has pinpointed the precise moment in 1960 during a meeting at Teen Murti Bhavan when he realised that the fellow revolutionary was now transformed as Prime Minister of India, inheriting the geopolitical inclination of the departed colonialist.

The big stick
More recently, India became progressively interventionist as Nepal got mired in internal crisis during and after the Maoist 'people's war', and as the hill-plain polarisation escalated during the constitution-writing. India has tended to speak loudly while wielding a big stick, based on a sense of entitlement and exceptionalism. But evidently, Indian nationalism for all its vigour cannot suppress nationalism across the frontier.

While there are of course nume-



PHOTO: SHANTANU DUTTA

rous domestic factors, a key reason for political instability in Nepal has been India's overt and covert interventions. This involvement explains in part why Nepal has not had a Prime Minister in office for more than a year and a half over two decades now. Meanwhile, Indian analysts fail to appreciate how political stability in Nepal can deliver economic bounty to the bordering Indian States on its three sides. And economists should study the Pew Research Center figures showing Nepal as one of the larger sources of remittances to India, that too to the poorest regions such as north Bihar, east Uttar Pradesh and Odisha.

India is understandably apprehensive as the Chinese geo-economic juggernaut infiltrates the Subcontinental countries, including Nepal. Rather than imperious warnings against co-opting with Beijing, however, better to leave each society to develop its own method on dealing with China. In the case of Nepal, the arrival of the Qinghai-Tibet Railway at the northern border point in 2020 will be a game-changer, and the Indian market too is set to benefit.

With Khasha Prasad Sharma Oli sworn in as Prime Minister on February 15, there is now opportunity to start afresh on India-Nepal. It is true that India has never had as adversarial a Prime Minister in Kathmandu as Mr. Oli, but this is mostly the result of New Delhi's own short-sightedness.

Mr. Oli has been a moderate (if loquacious) politician who does not bend easily to populist pressures, but it fell on him during his previous term to stand up to the devastating Great Blockade of 2015.

It became his job to rally a popu-



PHOTO: SHANTANU DUTTA

lance and seek connectivity northward through a set of 10 agreements with Chinese President Xi Jinping in Beijing.

Tagging Mr. Oli as 'anti-Indian' is not sensible, for being 'pro-Nepal' does not ipso facto mean animosity towards India. And New Delhi may be surprised to find Mr. Oli more than willing to reciprocate its overtures, providing reassurance that Kathmandu will never act against India's security interests, while insisting that in all areas Nepal will take its own decisions. Nepal's politicians are masters at realpolitik, and the art of balancing India vis-à-vis China is not outside of Mr. Oli's personal skill set.

Desire for harmony

Thankfully, it does look like India is seeking a recalibration, and no one is asking for a public apology. The desire for rapprochement is seen in the three-phase conversation Prime Minister Narendra Modi has had with Mr. Oli since December, and the dispatch of Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj to Kathmandu before the new government was even formed.

Nepal's topmost politicians, who never seem to retire, have got so used to revolving-door leadership that they are finding it hard to stomach the five-year term that the new government will probably get. On the other hand, the people's expectation is that the longevity will ipso facto make for better governance.

Mr. Oli's ascendance to prime-ministership marks the final turn of the key in implementing the Constitution of Nepal (2072), which was adopted despite India's fervent lobbying. The promulgation marks the end to the extended derailing of the last two decades, with numerous tragedies

from the Maoists 'people's war' to the Great Blockade.

Nepal is now a federal and secular republic, experimenting with three levels of fully empowered government – central, provincial and local. But there is confusion on the division of powers between the tiers, and foot-dragging by the national bureaucracy and many powerful politicians, besides an unimpeachable bench of the Supreme Court.

Ensuring inclusion

Mr. Oli inherits the share-the-spoils Bhagbada politics of the transitional years, which has left the police, bureaucracy and judiciary politicised. The decay in each sphere cries out for reform, from the private sector cartels that control the economy to corruption that has seeped to the village terraces.

The central socio-political task is to ensure inclusion in governance, giving the Janjati ethnicities as well as the Madhesi plains people and others a feeling of ownership of the state. While seeking to restore Nepal's position internationally, Mr. Oli has to implement the connectivity agreements he signed with Beijing in 2015, while lifting the relationship with India above the patron-client status. He will have his hands full trying to raise employment through tourism, industry, agroforestry and agribusiness, ensuring energy self-sufficiency through hydro projects and rescuing the post-earthquake reconstruction effort, which has been a scandal. With international assistance in decline, investors have to be attracted by the promise of the rule of law and due process if Nepal is not to remain the playground of carpetbaggers.

Speaking of the rule of law, the human rights community is worried that the ongoing truth and reconciliation process might be used as a sham exercise to pardon wartime atrocities. With Nepal recently elected to the UN Human Rights Council, there is opportunity to raise Nepal's international profile while finally putting the 'people's war' behind us all.

Mr. Oli is fortunate that the new Constitution ensures extended tenure, by not allowing a no-confi-

dence vote for the first two years. Besides, he rides a strong public mandate, having led the Left Alliance in its sweep of the local, provincial and national elections and forming governments at each tier. The field is also clear because the parties representing the Hinduva ideology and the deposed king, Gyanendra, were roundly defeated at all levels.

Reaching out

Mr. Oli's primary preoccupation will be managing the government's relationship with the opposition. The atmospherics between his Communist Party of Nepal (CPM) and the Nepali Congress (NC) are at their worst, the latter sullen and vulnerable after the tussling at the polls. He must reach out to build a working relationship with the NC and the Madheswadi plains-based parties, also because hundreds of new laws need to be urgently drafted under the Constitution.

The Prime Minister's immediate challenge, however, has to do with Pushpa Kamal Dahal ('Prachanda'), his Maoist partner in the Left Alliance. Mr. Dahal professes to ignore the reality that his party was rescued from decimation by the electoral bonding with the UML. The voters gave him a respectable showing, hoping that the promised unification would subsume the Maoists within the UML, helping finally to neutralise the former.

As this is being written, the two parties are preparing a unification document. Meanwhile, bargaining for plum posts, Mr. Dahal is demanding an alopalo, rotating prime-ministership. This would mean a jump back to Bhagbada politics, endangering both stability and growth, dishonouring the electoral mandate.

Prime Minister Oli is tasked today to lead Mr. Dahal where he can do no further harm to Nepal's state and society, and to reset the relationship with India at a new normal. On the latter, he seems keen to take the olive branch held out by Mr. Modi, which can only result in a 'win-win' for Nepal and India.

—
Kanak Mani Dixit, a writer and journalist based in Kathmandu, is founding editor of the magazine, 'Himal Southasia'

UPSC CSE – GS II

GS II ... India and Its Neighbourhood- Relations.

IMPORTANT QUESTION

ESSAY/ MAINS / GD / INTERVIEWS

In recent times, there is trust deficit in India-Nepal relations and Nepal is highly important, when one looks at geo-political and geo-strategic considerations. Critically examine.



AFGHANISTAN

CHINA

PAKISTAN

1,751 kms

INDIA

NEPAL

Sikkim

BHUTAN

Uttar Pradesh

Bihar

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

West Bengal

Arabian Sea

Bay of Bengal



Bihar	729
Uttar Pradesh	560
Uttarakhand	263
West Bengal	100
Sikkim	99
TOTAL	1,751



SPECIAL RELATIONSHIP INDIA - NEPAL



AS PER “1950 INDIA-NEPAL TREATY OF PEACE AND FRIENDSHIP”

- 1 Everlasting peace and friendship between India & Nepal
- 2 Both the countries should inform each other any serious friction or misunderstanding with any neighbouring state
- 3 Visa free travel
- 4 Open borders
- 5 Nepal can freely import arms & ammunition required for its safety & security through the territory of India
- 6 “National treatment” to the nationals of other country in industrial and economic development
- 7 Same privileges to nationals of other country in the matter of residence, ownership of property and participation in trade and commerce

*It resulted in “**Roti-Beti Relation**” of Terai region people especially Madhesis with the people of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh in India*

HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES

- 165 are directly elected on a First-Past-The-Post system (FPTP).
- 110 are elected on the basis of Proportional Representation (PR).



NATIONAL ASSEMBLY

- 59 member National Assembly consists of 8 members indirectly elected from each of the 7 provinces, and 3 nominated members.
- The elections are just like our Rajya Sabha elections.



WHO WON THE ELECTIONS?



K. P. Sharma Oli
Leader (CPN-UML)



Pushpa Kamal Dahal
Leader (CPN-MC)



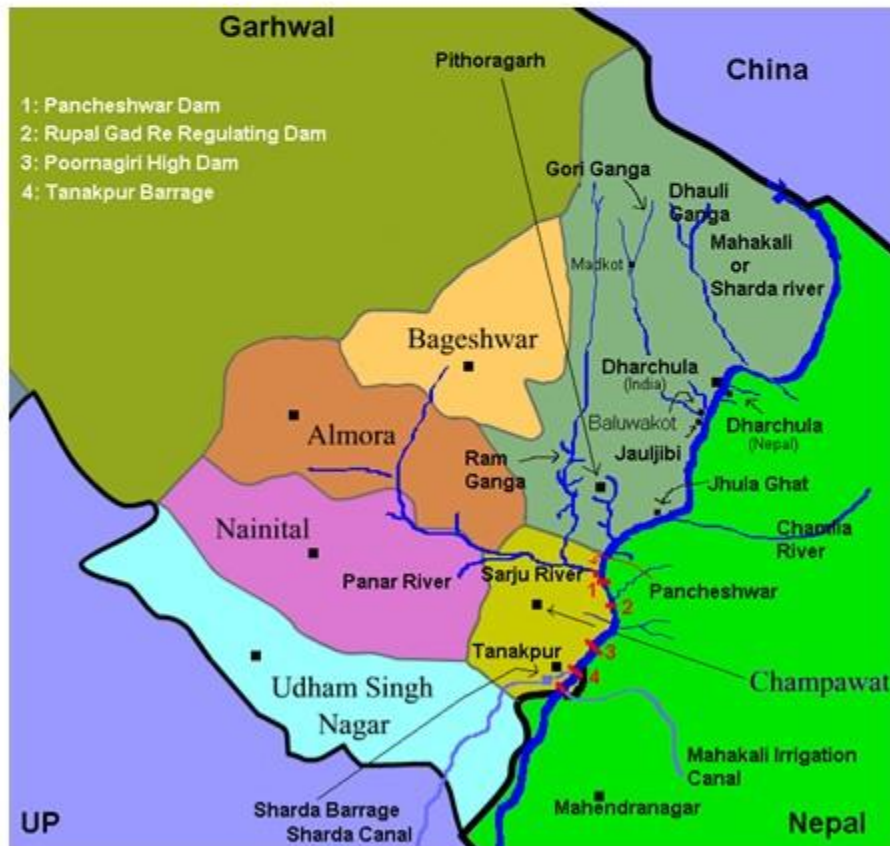
The Left Alliance won 174 seats in a House of 275.



Sher Bahadur Deuba
Nepali Congress



Pancheshwar Development Authority has been setup jointly by India and Nepal for execution, operation and maintenance of Pancheshwar multipurpose project on river sharda.



SALIENT POINTS

- Pancheshwar Development Authority (PDA) has been set up jointly by India and Nepal in 2014 for execution, operation and maintenance of the Pancheshwar Multipurpose Project on river Sharda.
- The Pancheshwar storage dam would play a significant role in mitigating floods.



The arrival of Qinghai Tibet Railway at the Northern Border point in 2020 will be game-changer for Nepal



NEPAL AND BIG BROTHER ATTITUDE OF INDIA

- 1 The legacy of Big Brother Attitude started with Jawaharlal Nehru
- 2 As the hill-plane polarisation escalated during the Constitution writing, India tried to speak loudly with a big stick.
- 3 One of the key reasons for political instability is India's overt and covert intercessions.
- 4 India should realise that the political stability in Nepal can deliver economic bounty to the bordering States especially North Bihar and Eastern Uttar Pradesh, because of the remittances to India.



KHADGA PRASAD SHARMA OLI
Prime Minister, Nepal



ERA OF KHADGA PRASAD SHARMA OLI STARTS AFRESH

- 1 He is moderate politician, who does not bend easily to the populist pressures.
- 2 During the previous term, he had to stand up to the devastating Great Blockade of 2015
- 3 He sought connectivity northward through a set of 10 agreements with China. Subsequently, he was termed as 'anti-Indian', but being 'pro-Nepal' does not mean animosity towards India.



INDIA AND RECALIBRATION OF RELATIONS

- 1 The Prime Minister had three phone calls with Mr.Oli
- 2 Foreign Minister Sushma Swaraj was sent to Kathmandu
- 3 Nepal is now a Federal and Secular Republic with three levels of fully empowered Government i.e., Central, Provincial, and Local

However, there is confusion on the division of powers between the tiers besides an untested Constitutional bench of the Supreme Court



NEED OF THE HOUR FOR MR.OLI

- 1** The Politicised bureaucracy, Police and Judiciary are to be improved.
- 2** Private Sector Cartels control the economy leading to corruption and this is to be looked at.
- 3** Janjati Ethnicities, as well as Madhesi plains people are to be included in the Governance, so as to have a feeling of ownership of the State
- 4** Relations with India are to be lifted.
- 5** Connectivity agreements with Beijing, which were signed in 2015, are to be honoured.
- 6** He should take steps to rise employment through tourism, industry, agro-forestry and agriculture.
- 7** It is to ensure energy self sufficiency through hydro projects.
- 8** Investors are to be attracted by the promise of rule of law.
- 9** Rescuing the post-earthquake reconstruction effort, which became a scandal.
- 10** Nepal recently elected to the UN Human Rights Council and there is a need to rise Nepal's International Profile.



The new Prime Minister Oli has to reset the relationship with India at a new normal, which can result in a win-win situation for Nepal and India.

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

Presented by



Learning Space

For Suggestions:

suggestions@learningspace.in

To Contact us:

info@learningspace.in

OUR TEAM

G. V. Rao

Amrita Naidu

D. Sunil Kumar

L. V. Krishna

D. Chaitanya

K. Srikanth

G. Ravi Babu

D. Joji

K. Victor Babu

Visit us at:

www.learningspacedigital.com

0 8 6 6 - 2 4 4 4 7 2

0 9 8 4 9 9 4 2 2 9 9